

1904

JAPAN AND RUSSIA AT WAR

Japanese-Russian tensions had mounted because of rivalry over Korea and Manchuria. Having made a surprise attack on the Russian fleet at Port Arthur, Manchuria, Japan declared war on Russia. Japanese forces defeated the Russians in a series of battles on land and at sea, finally destroying the Russian fleet at Tsushima Strait, ending the war in 1905. Japan gained Port Arthur and, in 1910, took over Korea.

▷ Naval battle in the Tsushima Strait, from an Italian newspaper



1904 Herero and Nama people rebel against German imperial rule in South West Africa (Namibia); they are put down brutally

1904

1904 The US begins construction of the Panama Canal; it will open in 1914



△ Boer War army discharge certificate

1902

SECOND BOER WAR ENDS

After more than two years of fighting between the British and Boers for control of the Transvaal and Orange Free State, the war ended with victory for the British. The Boers were initially successful, besieging Ladysmith, Kimberley, and Mafeking in 1900. However, British forces broke the siege and implemented a "scorched earth" policy, destroying Boer farms and incarcerating dispossessed Boer families in concentration camps.

1903-58 POWERED FLIGHT



Inventors of flying machines had little success until the early years of the 20th century. By the 1920s, passenger flights had begun.

1903 American inventors Orville and Wilbur Wright achieve the first sustained heavier-than-air flight; it lasts 12 seconds.



1915 The first all-metal aeroplane is designed by German engineer Hugo Junkers. It achieves a speed of 170 kph (105 mph).



1939 German engineer Hans von Ohain installs a jet engine in the experimental Heinkel He 178 plane, creating the world's first jet plane.



1958 The Boeing 707 sets the design for passenger jet airliners. With four engines, it can carry 190 passengers between continents.